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BOOK THREE

'AFTER the powers on high had approved* the destruction of Priam's
Innocent people and Asia's empire, Ilium's proud heights
Fell. All Neptune's Troy lay razed to the ground: ashes smoking.
Forced to pursue, by what we divined of the gods' will, our different,
5 Far-off places of exile, deserted lands, we constructed,
Under Antandros and under the ridges of Phrygian Ida,
Ships,* though we'd no idea where fate would take us or where we'd
Settle. We muster our men. By the early days of the summer,
Father Anchises is issuing orders to sail at the fates' call.
10 Tears in my eyes, I am leaving the shores of my homeland behind me,
Leaving the harbours and fields where Troy once stood. I'm an exile,
Borne on the deep with my comrades, my son, and our household's great gods.

'Far off lies Mars' special domain, vast arable flatlands
Ploughed by the Thracians and ruled, long ago, by savage Lycurgus.
15 Thrace, though, had long shared friendship with Troy, shared cult and religious
Ties—while Fortune held. Carried there, I established my first town,
Down on its curving shores, though the fates seemed to curse my arrival,
Called it Aeneadae*—simply a name we derived from my own name.
I began making my offerings now to my mother, Dione's
20 Child,* and to such other gods as might bless the work started. To honour
Jupiter, king of the gods, I was ready to slaughter a handsome
Bull on the shore. Nearby, as it chanced, stood a mound topped with dogwood
Clumps and some dense-packed thickets of bristling myrtle.
This I climbed. And I tried to uproot green wood from its groundsoil,
25 Eager to cover my altars with living and leaf-covered branches.
Just as I snapped the first shrub from its roots to extract it, I noticed
Something that made *me* bristle with fear, and which makes an astounding
Story; for dark blood started to ooze, dripping downwards in large drops,

Staining the soil with its putrid gore. A shudder of ice-cold
 30 Horror shivered my limbs. And my blood froze, clotted in terror.
 Still, I persisted, and tried once again to extract a reluctant
 Shaft from another bush, seeking the latent cause of the problem.
 Dark blood flowed from the bark of this second tree, in the same way.
 Thoughts crowded into my mind. I began saying prayers to the rural
 35 Nymphs and their father, Mars, under whose heavy heel lie the Thracian
 Fields, so they'd make what I'd witnessed a lighter, more favourable omen.
 'After I'd tackled a third group of shafts, and with even more effort,
 Wrestling, down on my knees, with the sand that resisted my struggles—
 Now—should I speak or be silent?—a moan that would drive you to heartbreak
 40 Rose to my ears from the depths of the mound; a voice drifted on breezes.
 "Why do you mutilate me? I have suffered, Aeneas, I'm buried!
 Spare me, and spare your own righteous hands from a crime. I'm a Trojan,
 Not some bizarre plant's shoot dripping ghastly blood; and you know me.
 Flee from this brutal land, get away from this greed-haunted seashore.
 45 I'm Polydorus;* and spiked into me was a seeding of iron
 Weapons which sprouted and yielded a harvest of sharp-pointed spear-shafts."*
 Fear then assumed a more complex face. Mind crushed by the portent,
 Stunned, hair standing on end, voice caught in my throat, I stood stock-still.
 'Priam, as ever, unfulfilled, had, earlier, sent off
 50 This Polydorus, loaded with gold, to be raised by the Thracian
 King. It was secretly done. Priam's confidence in the Dardanian
 Army was lost now; the city, he saw, was completely encircled.
 But, once Teucrian power was destroyed, deserted by Fortune,
 This king of Thrace chose the conquering side and he joined Agamemnon,
 55 Thus breaching all moral laws. He hacked Polydorus to pieces,
 Seized all the gold. Cursèd hunger for gold, is there no crime you won't drive

Mortal hearts to attempt?
 When my bone-chilling fear fled, I brought back
 News of these heaven-sent horrors to delegates picked by the people,
 And, above all, to my father. I asked for a judgement and ruling.
 60 All were of like mind: abandon this criminal land and escape its
 Fouled hospitality; we must sail with our fleet on the south winds.
 Therefore we give Polydorus a funeral. Over his earthen
 Mound an immense layer of topsoil is piled. His remains now have altars,
 Sombrely ribboned in black, wreathed dark with funereal cypress;

65 Women of Troy form a circle, hair ritually loose and unribboned.
 Next we bring bowls full of warm, frothing milk, bear chalices holding
 Blood from the sacrificed beasts, and we settle the soul of the dead man
 Deep in his tomb while our voices blare Last Call at the graveside.
 Then, just as soon as the main can be trusted, and winds give us lake-smooth
 70 Waters, and rustling softness of south winds summons us seaward,
 Sailors begin to haul ships to the surf, fanning over the beaches.
 Out of the harbour we sail, and the cities and land are receding.
 'In mid-sea there's a land held sacred, an island that's dearly
 Loved by the Nereids' mother and Neptune who rules the Aegean:
 75 Delos. It once drifted freely from this coast to that—till Apollo, the archer,
 Righteously tethered his birthplace to Mykonos and to the craggy
 Gyaros, granting it power to be still, and to laugh at the breezes.
 That's where I sailed.
 'The safe harbour of Delos gave tired crews its calmest
 Welcome.* When we disembarked, we paid homage to Phoebus's city.
 80 Anius* met us, the king, and not only the king but Apollo's
 Priest, with the god's holy laurels and ribbons encircling his temples.
 Seeing Anchises, he knew him at once as a friend from the old days.
 Handshakes and greetings exchanged, we stepped into the buildings before us.
 There I paid homage at Phoebus' ancient temple of hewn stone.
 85 "Give us a home of our own, god of Thymbra, give walls to the weary,
 Give us a future, a city that lasts. Preserve, for a new Troy,
 Pergamum's remnants missed by the Greeks and ungentle Achilles.
 Who do we follow? Or where do you tell us to go or to settle?

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Give us a sign to interpret, slip into our minds and inspire us!"
 90 'Hardly had I said this, when everything seemed to start shaking
 Suddenly, even the god's own gateway and laurels; the mountain
 Seemed to revolve and the tripod to roar as its shrine was hurled open.
 We threw ourselves to the ground, and our ears were assailed by a huge voice:
 "Dardanus' rugged sons:* the first land that nurtured your parents'
 95 Roots will, on your return, take you back to her welcoming bosom.
 Go, then, in careful search of your ancient, original mother!
 That's where Aeneas's house will establish a worldwide dominion,
 Kept by the sons of its sons and by those who'll be born of their offspring."
 Phoebus had spoken and happiness surged, though the sound of contention
 100 Mingled. They all wished to know what city was meant and precisely
 What land Phoebus was calling their wandering souls to return to.
 'Father's mind turned over the memories of old men in old times.

"Listen," he said, "you commanders, and learn what it is you can hope for.
 Crete, great Jupiter's isle, lies out in the midst of the high seas.
 105 There Mount Ida is found. It's the cradle of our people's being—
 Welcoming, well-peopled land, with a hundred considerable cities.
 That's where Teucer,* our father, had come from, if I now remember
 Rightly what I once heard, when he first went ashore at Rhoeteum.
 Wanting the place as his realm. No Ilium existed in those days,
 110 No Castle Pergamum. People just lived deep down in the valleys.
 Crete gave us our Great Mother* who lives in and blesses Cybelus,
 Gave us the Corybants' cymbals, the sacred woodlands of Ida,
 Cybele's sacraments hallowed by silence, her chariot's submissive
 Lions in yoked pairs. So: where gods' bidding leads, let us follow!
 115 Come, let's charm the good winds, let's sail for the kingdoms of Knossos!
 Crossing a distance so short will be easy, if Jupiter's with us.
 Dawn on the third day will see our vessels anchored on Cretan
 Shores." When he'd said this, he slaughtered appropriate beasts at the altars:
 Honouring Neptune, a bull; and a bull for you, lovely Apollo,

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120 Black is the sheep for the storm winds; white for the favouring zephyrs.
 'Rumour is flying that Idomeneus,* the king, is in exile,
 Cast from his father's throne, and that all Crete's shores are deserted:
That means no foe in the palace, and houses, abandoned, but standing.
 Leaving Ortygian Delos' port, we ourselves begin flying
 125 Over the seas, past the wildly Bacchic mountains of Naxos,
 Verdant Donysa, Olearos, snow-white Paros—the sea-strewn
 Cyclades—threading our way through waterways crowded with islands.
 Shouts from the sailors arise as they vie in their various contests:
 Crewmen, all urging us onwards to Crete, to the land of our fathers.
 130 Tailwinds rise, and they chase us along on the course we've been plotting.
 Soon we glide in on the ancient shores of a folk called Curetes.
 'Now I'm impatient. I'm building the walls of the city I've prayed for,
 Naming the place, to my people's delight, Pergamea, and urging
 All to feel love for their homes—and add height to the citadel's structures.
 135 'Sands underneath beached vessels were almost dry now, the young folk
 Busied with weddings, new lands for the plough. I myself was allotting
 Homes, I was drafting laws. Then, suddenly, out of some sickened
 Part of the heavens, a plague fell upon us. It rotted our bodies,
 Piteously blighted our trees and our crops. What a year of destruction!
 140 People let go of the sweet breath of life or they dragged ailing bodies

Painfully. Sirius' heat withered growth on our farms in the summer.
Grasslands parched and the ailing crops refused us their nurture.
"Back to the Delian oracle, trace back your sea-routes to Phoebus!"
That's what my father was urging. "And pray that he grant us forgiveness,
145 Ask him what end he can bring to this state of exhaustion, what helpful
Sources he bids us approach in our toils, what land we should sail to."

'Night reigned; sleep was controlling earth and its living and conscious
Creatures.* And my sleeping mind saw, standing in front of my own closed

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Eyes, holy statues of gods and the household spirits of Phrygia—
150 Effigies I'd brought with me from Troy, refugees from the blazing
City. They stood forth, clear in the generous light which the full moon
Poured through the slats of the shutters. And then they appeared to address me,
Uttering words to allay my concerns,* and expressing them this way:
"All that Apollo intends to declare when you reach his Ortygian
155 Delos, he sings for you here. See, he's sent us directly to *your* home!
We, when the Dardan city was burned, followed you and your forces,
We measured great sea's swelling expanse under you, and with your fleet,
And it is we who will raise your descendants high to the heavens;
We'll give your city imperial power. You must furnish that mighty
160 Future with mighty defences. Don't give up your flight and its long toil!
Move, as you must, from this place! It's not *this* land the Delian suggested;
Crete's not the place where Apollo's instructions advised you to settle.
But such a place does exist. It's an ancient land called Hesperia,
'Twilight Land',* by the Greeks, strong in armies, rich in its cropfields.
165 Once the Oenotrians tilled it. Now rumour reports that successors
Renamed it 'Italy' after the family name of their leader.
That's where it's right that we settle: where Dardanus came from, and also
Father Iasius. They are the ultimate source of our bloodlines.
Come on, get up! And report what we've said to your elderly father
170 Joyfully. It's beyond doubt! Let him seek out Corythus, seek out
Lands in Ausonia. Jupiter's dictates ban you from Dicte."*
'Struck by such visions and voices of gods as by thunder, I leaped up.
These were no phantoms of sleep, but known identities, witnessed
Closely. I seemed to be seeing their veiled hair, actual faces.
175 Icy sweat was beginning to seep from all over my body.
Out of my bed in a flash, I stretched hands high toward heaven,
Palms facing up, voice raised. Then I poured out the purest libations
Over the fires. When content that I'd done all the ritual honours,

I told the news to Anchises, expounding the details in order.

- 180 Grasping that there were two lines in our ancestry, twin sets of parents,
Seeing that he'd been misled by a new error mixing up old sites,

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"Son," he recalled, "you who've anguished so much about Ilium's future,
Only Cassandra kept singing to me about this sort of outcome.

- Now, as I think back, she claimed this land was our family's due realm,
185 Often she'd talk of Hesperia, often of Italy's kingdoms.
Who'd believe Teucrians, though, would arrive on Hesperia's beaches,
Who, at the time, could be stirred, anyway, by Cassandra's predictions?
Let's go along with what Phoebus advises. It's better. Let's follow."
That's what he said. We all cheered in our joy and obeyed his instructions.

- 190 'So, we deserted this settlement too—leaving only a small group—
Sails set, speeding across vast seas in our hollows of timber.
After our vessels gained open seas, as we sighted no further
Land, saw sea on all sides, up above saw only the heavens,
Rain clouds, black as the deep, formed over our heads, bringing with them
195 Night-time and winter gales, seas shuddering, stippled with darkness.
Instantly winds roll water to waves; sea's immensity surges
Huge. We are scattered and tossed in its spinning and suctioning vastness.
Black storms smother the day, night's darkness rips away heaven,
Fire flashes out from exploding clouds, forks thunderously doubled.

- 200 Shaken off course we are wandering, lost in the blindness of water.
And Palinurus himself says he cannot distinguish in heaven
Day from night, or remember the course in the midst of the high seas.
Three full cycles of unseen sun we wander in sultry
Darkness over the deep, the same number of nights without starlight.

- 205 'Then, on the fourth day, at last, land seems to emerge for the first time,
Opening distant vistas of mountains and billowing smoke plumes.
Down goes the canvas, we rush to the oars; in an instant the sailors'
Muscles are churning foam as strokes sweep wide on the blue deep.

- 'Strophades is what the Greeks call the islands whose coastlands receive me
210 First, as I'm saved from the waves, Strophades in the spreading Ionian
Sea. There the Demon Celaeno, along with the rest of the Harpies,*

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Dwells, now that Phineus' door has been closed to their hunger,
Forcing the creatures, in fear, to give up their old banqueting tables.
No grimmer monster than these, worse plague, or divine show of anger

215 Ever protruded its fiendish head from Stygian waters:
 Harpies can fly; they have faces like girls', and discharge from their bellies
 Foulest filth. They have hands like claws, they have cheeks ever pallid,
 Hungering mouths.
 'Once we've arrived and have entered the port, what a vista before us!
 220 Herds of contented cattle that graze at will in the meadows,
 Goats flocking, cropping the grass—no herdsman to watch or control them.
 In we rush.* And we butcher them all, and invite the gods' presence,
 Specially Jupiter, so they too may share in our plunder.
 Next, on the curving beach we set couches and dine there superbly.
 225 'Then, in a sudden and spine chilling swoop from the mountains, the Harpies
 Pounce in a flash and wreak havoc with thunderous clangour of wingbeats,
 Tearing our banquet to pieces, their unclean contact befouling
 Everything. Hellish screeching resounds in the midst of a vile stench.
 So, in a deep recess, under cliffs hollowed out by erosion,
 230 Covered above with a woodland canopy—trees and their bristling
 Shadows encircle it—we set our tables again and rekindle
 Altar fires. And again, from their unseen lairs, from a different
 Quarter, the screeching mob, talons poised, flies over the plunder,
 Fouling the feast with their mouths. So I order my crews to grab weapons,
 235 War, I declare, must now be waged with this nation of fiends.
 Acting precisely as ordered, they hide their swords, which they scatter
 Various over the grass, bury shields where they can't be detected.
 So, when the foe swoops, blaring its screech through the curve of the seashore,
 High in his sentinel post, Misenus, with hollow brass trumpet,
 240 Sounds the alarm. Then my comrades attack in a new form of battle,
 Try to dismember with steel these foul, disgustatory seabirds.*
 They, unscarred by wounds to their backs or blows to their plumage,
 Swiftly soar to the stars, while leaving behind them their carrion

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Half-eaten, torn from the tables now spoiled with the marks of their foulness.
 245 'One of them perches on top of a very high cliff: she's Celaeno,
 Prophet of failed fulfilment for us. She breaks forth with these words:
 "Sons of Laomedon,* are you prepared to wage war on the Harpies,
 War for our bulls, which you butchered, and over our cows, which you slaughtered,
 And to expel us, who've done you no harm, from the land of our fathers?
 250 Carry on into your minds* my words, then. Grasp them securely.
 These are predictions the Father Almighty gave Phoebus Apollo,
 Phoebus told me. Now I pass them to you, I, direst of Demons.*
 Italy's where you're steering your course. You'll summon up fair winds,

You'll be allowed to reach Italy's coast, to sail into her harbours.
 255 But you will never surround your allotted city with ramparts
 Till dire famine* avenging the wrong done to us by this slaughter
 Drives you to gnaw with your jaws at your tables and then to devour them."
 This said, she rose on her wings and flew back to the sheltering forest.
 'Blood froze rigid as ice in my comrades' veins at this sudden,
 260 Frightening vision. Their spirits fell. Their demand was no longer
 Peace won by warfare, but peace won by offerings, prayers, and petitions,
 Whether these beings were gods or disgusting birds of ill-omen.
 Palms stretched upwards in prayer, on the shore, my father, Anchises,
 Calls upon heaven's great powers and offers them ritual honours:
 265 "Gods, keep us safe from these threats! O gods, please avert such disaster!
 Grant to the righteous salvation and peace." Then he orders the moorings
 Slipped and the yard ropes loosed, all sail unfurled for departure.
 Southerlies belly the canvas, we flee, wake foaming behind us.

'Setting a course now mapped by a helmsman and guided by breezes.
 270 On the horizon we soon catch glimpses of wooded Zacynthus,
 Samë, Dulichium, Neritus too, raised high on its steep cliffs,
 Far to our leeward, we hold craggy Ithaca, realm of Laërtes.
 Roundly cursing this land which had suckled the savage Ulysses.
 Leucas's cloudy peaks* soon appear, and its shrine of Apollo,
 275 Shores that a sailor would normally dread; but we, now exhausted,

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Set a direct course towards it, put in at its miniature city.
 Anchor is cast from the prow; ship's sterns stand beached on the seashore.
 Since we've at last achieved landfall, unplanned, yet beyond all our wildest
 Hopes, we now wash ourselves clean, and, in Jupiter's honour, set altars
 280 Blazing with gifts, hold Ilian games upon Actium's beaches.
 Naked and slippery with oil, my crews do traditional Trojan
 Wrestling, delighted we've safely eluded the grip of so many
 Argive cities, effected escape through the midst of our foemen.
 'Meanwhile, the sun has completed one more long year in its orbit;
 285 Icy winter churns seas wild with the blasts of the north wind.
 Out on the gateposts, I nail up a shield made of bronze, hammered concave,
 Carried by great Abas once, and inscribe my gift with a poem:
 "Arms from Danaän victors,* these, and vowed by Aeneas."
 Then I give orders to leave our haven and get to the benches.
 290 Crews compete, strike sea with their oars, sweep over the surface.
 Quickly we tuck out of sight* Phaeacia's mist-covered towers,

Skirt past the Epirote shoreline and enter Chaonian harbours,
Drawing in close to the lofty heights of a city: Buthrotum.

'Here, our ears are assailed by a true but incredible rumour:

- 295 Helenus, Priam's son,* now possesses the wife and the sceptre
Once held by Pyrrhus, of Aeacus' blood. He's a king and he's ruling
Greek cities. Once more Andromache marries a man from her homeland!
Stunned, I could feel my heart overcome by astonished and burning
Passion to talk to the man, learn the cause of events so momentous.
300 Leaving the shore and my navy, I made my way up from the harbour,
Just as Andromache chanced to be standing in front of the city.
There in a grove by the streams of a make-believe Simoïs, she held
Rites of remembrance, with food for the dead, sad gifts, and libations,
Calling on Hector's empty tomb that she'd hallowed with green turf,
305 And upon altars, twinned, like the cause of her tears: son and husband.
'When she observed me approaching and saw, in a panic, our Trojan
Arms all round, she reacted in terror as if to a monstrous

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Phantasm, stiffening in mid-glance. Warmth fled her bones and she fainted.
Finally, after a long time had passed, she could speak,* but just barely.

- 310 "You! Is it really your face I see, really telling me you're here?
Son of the goddess, are you still alive? Or, if sweet light has left me,
Where's Hector?" Speech now yielded to streaming tears as her loud cries
Flooded the whole place. And while she was out of control, I could scarcely
Slip a few words in. Confused, I began with a phrase here, a phrase there:
315 "I am alive. Yes it's me, though I lead a life stretched to my limits.
Don't doubt it. What you are seeing is real.
Oh, what befell to uplift you,* when left cast down by your great spouse?
Hector's Andromache, say what worthy—well, adequate—Fortune
Visits you? Do you maintain your spousal relations* with Pyrrhus?"
320 'Head bowed, eyes downcast, voice down to a murmur, she answered:
"How much more fulfilled than the rest of us women was Priam's
Single daughter left virgin,* and ordered to die on a foe's grave
Under the high walls of Troy. She was never the prize in a raffle,
Shamed as a captive to feel the touch of her winner and master's
325 Bedding. But we, when they'd burned up our homeland, were split up and shipped
off
Far away over the seas. I bore the conceit of Achilles'
Offshoot, arrogant youth, bore the pains of birth as his slave-girl.
He, then, went chasing Hermione, Leda's grandchild, a decent

Lacedaemonian wedding!—signed over the rights to his housemaid,
 330 Me, to a house-slave, Helenus, but—now enter Orestes,*
 Blazing with passionate love for the girl (who's the wife he's been robbed of).
 Maddened by ghosts of his crimes he catches his rival when off guard,
 Butchering him at his father's shrine. Neoptolemus now dead,
 Deeds assign Helenus part of his realm, and he names it for Trojan
 335 Chaon—hence the 'Chaonian Plains' and the region, 'Chaonia'—
 And, on the heights, he sets Pergamum too, and an Ilian fortress.
 But what winds, what forces of fate, set *you* on a course here?

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Did some god drive you here to the shores you did not know were ours?
 What of your son? Did Ascanius survive, is he living and thriving?
 340 He's the one Troy left you ...
 Does he still grieve now for his lost mother,* and does his father's
 Fame, does Aeneas inspire him to old-fashioned courage, a real man's
 Greatness of soul, does the thought that his uncle was Hector inspire him?"
 Words like these, intermingled with tears, she continued to pour forth,
 345 Raising a lengthy and hopeless lament, as the hero, as Priam's
 Son, made his way from the walls, with a sizeable group of retainers.
 Helenus knows us as kinsmen and ushers us into his city
 Joyfully, though each word has to sob through the flood* of his weeping.
 On getting closer I know it: a miniature Troy, simulating
 350 Mighty Pergamum, even a bone-dry creek that is now named
 Xanthus. And I'm at the Scaean Gate, and embracing its threshold.
 Teucrians too find similar joy in this city of kinsmen,
 Ample courtyards enabled the king to admit their whole number.
 Out in the centre, they started to offer libations to Bacchus,
 355 Sacred feasts, set on service of gold, great chalices held high.

'Day followed day in procession, another, another. The breezes
 Cried for our sails, and persistent southerlies bellied the canvas.
 Statements and questions like these on my lips, I go up to the prophet:
 "Helenus, born within Troy, translator of gods, you decipher
 360 Phoebus' will, his oracular tripods, his laurel of Claros,
 Movements of stars, birds' language and ominous patterns of flying.
 Speak to me. Every traditional source has been kind and informed me
 Where I should go; all the powers above, in their signs, recommended
 Sailing for Italy, testing out lands far off in the distance.
 365 Only the Harpy Celaeno proclaims new omens, abhorrent
 Even to name, invokes curses of vengeance upon us: disgusting

Famine. So what are the first of the hazards I should be avoiding?
What course must I pursue to ensure we survive all these troubles?"

'Helenus' first response was the ritual slaughter of heifers,

370 Prior to begging the gods to grant peace. Then he stripped off the ribbons
Binding his sacred hair, and, since such intense divine pressures
Paralysed me, took my hand, led me into your temple, Apollo.

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There, as a priest with divine inspiration, he sang these predictions:

"Son of the goddess: that you're being guided and watched by some major

375 Powers as you travel the deep is quite obviously true. For God's ruler
Thus divides fate into lots, creates change. That's how order progresses.
Of these numerous signs, I'll translate you a few into verbal
Form: so you'll find safer passage, while guest of the seas, so you *can* then
Reach an Ausonian port. But the Fates prevent Helenus knowing

380 All the remainder; and speaking them's banned by Saturnian Juno.

' "In the beginning, this Italy you think close and whose harbours,
Ignorant man,* you're preparing to wade to as if they were next door,
Lies aloof, long lands away on a long, impassable passage.

Ere you arrive, your oar must be slowed by Trinacrian waters,
385 Leagues of Ausonian seaways must also be crossed by your vessels,
Lakes of the underworld too, and Circe's island, Aeaëa.

Only then may you find safe land to assemble your city.

Signs there will be. I will tell you them. Store them deep in your memory.

' "When, under pressure, you come to the streams of a well-hidden river,

390 Under the bankside's oak-shrub brush you'll find an immense sow
Lying sprawled on the soil, on her side—an albino, with thirty
Newborn piglets, albino themselves, at her teats in a cluster.*

This is the seat for your future state and your refuge from troubles.

Don't live in terror about this impending gnawing of tables.

395 Fates will discover a way;* when you call him, Apollo will be there.

But, stay clear of the shores and the lands around Italy's closest

Coasts, those washed by the swell from our own Ionian waters.

All the communities there have been settled by Greeks who are wicked.

Locrians, Ajax's people from Naryx built walls there, and that's where

400 Idomeneus from Lyctos encamped, with his troops, on Salento's
Broad plains. Terraced Petelia, too. It is tiny but famous;

Now Philoctetes' abode, since he fled from his home, Meliboea.

Then, once your fleet has completed its mission and halted its motion,

While setting altars down by the shore, making good all your solemn

405 Vows, you must cover your hair with a veiling mantle of purple*

So that no evil-eyed enemy face can intrude on your hallowed

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Flames lit to honour the gods, thereby disrupting the omens.

You, both your crew and yourself, make this a religious tradition!

May your descendants maintain this rite with unceasing devotion!

- 410 ' "Then, when you set sail again, when the wind moves you on to Sicilian
Shores, where Pelorus' tongue-slim promontory narrows to nothing,
Run, though it makes for a lengthy loop, for the land to the larboard,
Larboard seas. Steer clear of the shores and the waters to starboard.
These two regions once formed a single, contiguous landmass,
415 Then, it is said, they rifted apart in a vast, devastating
Earthquake. Remote antiquity's hugeness of time can accomplish
Changes like this. In a violent flood, sea gushed through the chasm,
Severed Hesperian flank from Sicilian, washed with its narrow
Rip-tides between ploughed fields, between cities now sundered by coastlines.
420 Scylla keeps watch on the starboard side; on the larboard, Charybdis
Suctions vast waves down an abyss spun deep by her whirling
Spirals of tides three times each day; then, reversing her motion,
Vomits them up to the skies, strikes stars with a whiplash of water.
Scylla, confined to a cavern's concealing protection of darkness,
425 Constantly darts out her mouth, drags ships onto reefs of destruction.
First glance shows one a human face and a girl with a pretty
Torso, as far as the groin. But below that, a sea-serpent's monstrous
Body with wolfish bellies that merge into dolphin-like tail flukes.
Take time! Better to double Trinacria's Cape of Pachynus,
430 Though it's a long and circuitous course, than to get just a single
Glimpse of deformed Scylla lurking within her cavernous vastness
And hear the reef's ringing echoes as dark hounds bark amid breakers.
' "If, in addition, this seer, your Helenus, has any foresight,
If one can trust him at all and his soul is replete with Apollo's
435 Truths, I'll predict one thing to you, son of the goddess, just one thing;
Over and over again I'll repeat this advice and this warning:
Juno's great force *must be the first* you respect in your prayers,
Sing to her heartfelt vows, win over this powerful mistress,
Juno, with gifts, on your knees. That way, in the end, you will triumph,
440 Leave the Trinacrian land, and be sent on to Italy's borders.
' "When you've arrived there and made your approach to the city of Cumae,

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Lakes dedicated to gods and Avernus's echoing forests,

Then you'll observe a mad seer* who sings, from the depths of a cavern,
 Fate's decrees, using leaves to record all names and all details.
 445 Each word this virgin writes upon leaves as her song of the future,
 She then arranges in sequence and stores in her cave, behind locked doors.
 These all stay unmoved, and in place, never fall out of order.
 But, just the slightest draught, as the door rotates on its hinges,
 Blows them away. For its opening scatters the featherlike foliage.
 450 All through her hollow cave leaves flutter, but she never bothers,
 After this happens, to catch, to replace, or assemble the verses.
 People go off without answers, detesting the shrine of the Sibyl.
 Don't count the cost of delay very high when you visit. No matter
 How crews grumble, how strongly your voyage demands that you set sail
 455 Now, or what favouring winds now blow and would belly your canvas,
 Don't fail to go to the seer. Ask, *beg* her, to open her own throat,
 Sing you her oracles willingly, orally, now, and in person.
 She'll tell you all about Italy's peoples, and wars that are coming,
 What methods you should employ to avoid or endure every problem.
 460 And, if you show her respect, she will grant you success in your journeys.
 That's it. No further warnings to you from my voice are permitted.
 Forward! And with your deeds, raise Troy's great name to the heavens!"
 'Such were his friendly words. And the seer orders gifts to be carried
 Onto my ships: items heavy with gold and with sawn elephantine
 465 Ivory,* loading the keels with a huge store of silver and cauldrons
 Brought from Dodona.* Among these is Neoptolemus' armour,
 Namely a corslet of interlocked loops interwoven with tripled
 Gold, and a helmet beautifully coned, topped off with a handsome
 Horsehair crest. And my father, too, receives personal presents.
 470 Also he adds horses, adds a few pilots,
 Strengthens our benches with rowers, supplies new equipment for crewmen.

'Meanwhile, Anchises was issuing orders to get the fleet's rigging
 Ready for sail so there'd be no delay should a favouring wind rise.
 Phoebus' spokesman approached him with great deferential politeness:
 475 "You were thought worthy, Anchises, of proud honour, marriage to Venus,

.....
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You're the gods' special concern, twice rescued from Pergamum's ruin,
 Look, there it is, your Ausonian land! Hoist canvas and take it!
 Yet—you *really must* glide past the near coast on the high seas:
 Phoebus Apollo shows *you* the distant Ausonian west coast.
 480 Forward!" he cries. "Your righteous son brings hopes to fulfilment!

Why am I talking so much and delaying the south winds? They're rising!"

'Saddened by this last parting, Andromache too offered presents:
Garments embroidered with figures of gold threaded into the fabric,
And, for Ascanius, a Phrygian cloak* (he wasn't forgotten!).

485 Weighing him down with her textile gifts, she spoke much as follows:

"Take these too. May my hands' work serve you as memorials,
Witnessing, dear boy, the lasting love of Andromache, Hector's
Wife. Take these. They're the final gifts that your kinsmen can give you,
You, sole image surviving to me of Astyanax, my son.

490 You have his eyes, hands, face, his expressions, precisely his movements.

He would be your age now: a youth on the threshold of manhood."

'I told them as I went on my way with tears flowing freely:

"Live fulfilled lives, you whose struggles with fortune are over
Now. We're *still* being challenged by one fate after another.

495 You're celebrating the birth of your stillness; no more ploughing salt seas

Nor any quest for Ausonian fields that are always receding
Farther away. You see Xanthus's image, a Troy that your own hands
Built under auspices which, I hope, prove better, a Troy that
Might prove less of a hindrance to Greeks.* Should it be that I ever

500 Enter the Tiber and enter the ploughlands bordering the Tiber,

See the walls granted my people, some distant day in the future,
We'll bring our two states together, uniting our neighbouring nations,
Linking Hesperia to Epirus. This same Dardanus founded
Both of our bloodlines, each bore identical hardships. In each mind

505 Troy shall be one and the same. Here's a task for our grandsons to settle!"

'Northward we press on the sea, with Ceraunia's ridges to starboard,
Gaining the point from which Italy's reached by the shortest of crossings.*
Sun sets, dense dark mountains now merge deep into shadows.

.....
pg 70

There we lie in the welcome dry land's lap, near the water,

510 Clasping the oars we're allotted, and randomly sprawled on the dry sand,

Tending our bodies, as sleep pours balm over limbs now exhausted.

Night, driven on by the Hours, wasn't yet approaching its mid-point

When Palinurus, always alert, leaped up from his bedroll,

Checked all the winds, gauged movements of air with his sensitive hearing,

515 Marked the progression of stars* in the silence of heaven: Arcturus,

Hyades, promising rain, he observes, the Triones, the twin Bears,

Also Orion with weapons of gold. When his survey's completed—

All observations concur that the sky is serene—he then signals

Clearly from up on the aft-deck; and we break camp for departure.
520 Sails unfurled are our wings as we start our attempt at a crossing.
 'Dawn is now duly blushing to red and the stars have been routed
When we see dim, vague hills in the distance and, low in its profile,
Italy. "Italy!" shouted Achates who first hailed the sighting,
"Italy!" sang out the crew in a joyful and clamorous greeting.
525 Father Anchises then circled a mixing bowl with a garland,
Filled it with unmixed wine* and, standing high on the aft-deck,
Voiced his appeal to the gods.
 "Gods who have power over sea, over earth, over sky and its tempests,
Grant us a crossing eased by a wind, breathe favourably on us!"
530 Breezes pick up, as we've hoped. There's a port, getting closer and closer;
High on Minerva's Castle, a temple appears. So the sailors
Shorten their sail, swing about all prows on a tack for the coastline.
Pounding seas from the east have curved this port in a bow-shape.
Spits jutting outwards foam with the spattering spray of the salt sea,
535 Hiding the actual harbour, formed by the downward extending
Spurs of a turreted ridge which create two embankments. The temple
Backs far away from the shore. Here I saw the first omen, four horses
White as the snow, freely ranging the flat plains, cropping the grasses.
Father Anchises observed: "Host land, you are bringing us warfare.
540 Horses are bridled for war and it's war that these animals threaten.
These same four-footed creatures, though, may be trained for the chariot*
Some day and, yoked, may produce that concord born of the harness.
Peace can be hoped for."

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'We then offered prayers to a sacred, divine power:
Pallas the Armoured, who greeted us first when we landed triumphant.
Then, just as Helenus had so emphatically ordered, we duly
545 Veiled our heads, as we stood before altars, in Phrygian mantles,
And honoured Juno the Argive by burning the specified offerings.
Once we'd completed our rites in due order, we instantly started
Hauling the rig on the masts and the yards of our sails round to windward,
550 Leaving behind us the port, Greek towns, and the land we mistrusted.

'Next into view comes the bay of Tarentum which, rightly or wrongly,
Rumour had Hercules visit. Lacinium's temple of Juno
Rises to face it, then Caulon's heights, Scylla's headland, the sailor's
Graveyard.* Far off, up from the swell, Trinacrian Etna
555 Looms into view. We hear monstrously roaring seas thunder over

Outcrops of rock, voices screaming on coasts, fragmented by distance,
 Shoals leaping high in a riotous dance, sand swirling in sea's surge.
 Father Anchises observes: "This must be the famous Charybdis.
 These are the crags and the jagged reefs named in Helenus' warning.
 560 Comrades, get us away! Be a team! Put your backs into rowing."
 'Crews do no less than they're ordered. The first to respond, Palinurus,
 Torques ropes, forces the rasping prow hard over to larboard;
 Each crew veers to a larboard tack, under oar-power and canvas.
 Up to the heavens we're raised on the spiralling waves, the next moment
 565 Down we sink to the depths of the dead as the waters are sucked back.
 Three times cliffs amid hollows of rock roar thunderous echoes;
 Three times we see foam wash clear, see stars dripping water.
 Meanwhile the wind and the daylight abandon us, leave us exhausted.
 Not knowing where we are, we've beached on the shores of the Cyclops.
 570 'Huge and calm as the harbour itself is, for no breezes enter,
 Nearby Etna thunders horrific cascades of destruction.
 Sometimes she shoots dark clouds up high, enshrouding the heavens,

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Billows out eddying pitch-black smoke, ash blazing and white hot,
 Catapults fiery globes, great flames which lick at the gleaming
 575 Stars. And she'll sometimes hurl forth crags, she will tear out and vomit
 Her own mountainous guts, she'll boil into air, from her deepest
 Pits, rocks liquefied, rounded, with painful groans, into lava.
 'Rumour contends that beneath her mass, Enceladus' body*
 Lies trapped, charred by a thunderbolt. Over him, hugeness on hugeness,
 580 Etna was placed, and she bellows out flame where her furnaces rupture.
 Each time he tires and turns on his side, Trinacria's whole mass
 Shudders and roars, and envelops the sky in a mantle of dark smoke.
 'During that night we endured, under forestland cover, appalling
 Horrors. And, further, we just couldn't see what was causing the noises.
 585 No star's gleam, no luminous vault with its bright constellations
 Offered us light. There were overcast skies, fog-shrouded, entombing
 Moon in a dungeon of cloud; it was night without time, utter darkness.

'Now it's the next day. Dawn, as the first gleam of sun at its rising,
 Sweeps away dankness of shadowy dark from the vault of the heavens.
 590 Suddenly, out of the forest, a figure appears, unlike any
 We've ever seen, starved gaunt, quite pitifully squalid—an unknown
 Man coming down to the shore, hands outstretched, begging for mercy.
 We just stare. Though his filth is disgusting, his beard in an untrimmed

Tangle, what passes for clothes sewn together with thorns, he's in all else
595 Greek, once sent against Troy in his father's inherited armour.

'He, when he noticed our Trojan attire, when he glimpsed, at a distance,
Armour from Troy, stopped short in his tracks. What he saw, for an instant,
Froze him in terror. He soon made a dash for the shore, though, imploring,
Tears in his eyes: "May the stars, may the powers above bear me witness,
600 May this light we absorb from the sky now support my petition:
Teucrians, take me away, take me where in the world it may please you.
That's all I ask. Yes, I know I'm a man from the fleet of Danaäns,
And I admit that I came to attack Troy's temples and households.

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If damage done by my crime is too great, then punish my actions,
605 Scatter me, limb by limb on the waves, plunge me into the vast sea.
If I'm to die, I will happily die at the hands of a human."
This said, he clung to my knees as he swayed on his own: a determined
Suppliant. He wouldn't budge. "Who are you?" we urge him to tell us.
"Tell us about your family, explain what caused your misfortunes."
610 Father Anchises himself took his hand* with but slight hesitation,
Giving the youth courage, building it, through this significant gesture.

'He, when at last he's recovered from fright, tells us this as his story:
'I am from Ithaca; I served Ulysses who found no fulfilment;
I'm Achaemenides. Since Adamastus, my father, had nothing—
615 Oh, staying poor would have been good fortune for me!—I set off for
Troy. But it's here my companions marooned me. While nervously slipping
Out past the gate of our brutal confinement, they didn't remember
Me in the Cyclops' monstrous cave.
' "Inside, it's enormous,
Dark. It's a filthy home for a banquet of blood. He's gigantic,
620 High as the stars (gods, keep earth free of such pestilent creatures!).
Looking at him isn't easy; conversing is out of the question.
Victuals, for him, are his victims' vital sinews and dark blood.
I myself have watched as he scooped two members of our group
Up in his massive hand, then reclined in the heart of the cavern,
625 Cracked them on rock, spraying fluids and filth that left entrances
Swimming. I've watched as he gnawed through limbs still awash with and pulsing
Gore, I've seen warm, living tendons responding to teeth with a shudder.
Not that they died unavenged. This was not let pass by Ulysses.
Ithaca's son, in this crisis, did not lose his veteran cunning.
630 ' "Once Polyphemus was gorged with his feast, and the wine had embalmed him,

Once he had lain down his drooping neck, his immensity sprawling
All through the cave, as he vomited up, in his sleep, half-digested
Chunks, gore-clots all blended with blood-thick, previously unmixed
Wine, we prayed to the great divine powers, drew lots, and, in one wave,
635 Poured in a circle around him and bored, with a sharply honed weapon,

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Clear through his huge, sole, luminous eye set deep in his fierce brow,
Large as an Argive shield or the solar lantern of Phoebus.
Thus, with delight, we at last avenged the shades of our comrades.
"But get away, poor fools, get away, break the ropes from their shoreside
640 Moorings!
This Polyphemus who milks woolly flocks and who uses a hollow
Cave to enclose them is not unique in his size or his nature.
There are a hundred more indescribable Cyclopes, whole clans,
Living along this curving coast, roaming high in the mountains.
645 Now, for the third time, the moon's bright horns are rounding to full light.
That's how long I've been eking out life in the woods, through deserted
Wild beast ranges and lairs, keeping watch, from a cliff, on the monstrous
Cyclopes, trembling at thumps of their footfalls, sounds of their voices.
Branches yield me an unfulfilling diet of berries,
650 Stony cornelian cherries; I graze upon grass I've uprooted.
This, though I've constantly watched all seas, is the first fleet I've spotted
Putting ashore. I had sworn I would yield to whatever that first group
Turned out to be, just content to escape these unspeakable people.
I'd rather you take my life—and by any death whatsoever."
655 'Almost before he has finished, we see Polyphemus: a shepherd
Moving around among flocks on the top of a mountain, and vastly
Huge. He is making his way to the shores that he knows—an enormous,
Monster so ugly and fearsome, his sole eye ravaged and sightless,
Crutching his hand and supporting his feet on a pine stripped of branches.
660 Wool-bearing sheep give him company—they are the one consolation,
Sole pleasure left for his pain.
Once he's arrived at the sea and detected the touch of the high waves,
Groaning, and grinding his teeth, he rinses the blood that still oozes
Out of his gouged-out eyesight. He's wading far into the sea now
665 But waves still don't reach all the way to his towering ribcage.
We, in a panicky rush to escape far away from the region,
Take our deserving suppliant aboard, slash hawsers in silence,

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Churn seas up, flat out at our oars, in a race for survival.

'Sensing the movements, he twisted his steps toward the sound of our voices.

- 670 When opportunity fails to empower his hand, when his own powers
Waver, unseasoned for chasing us over the deeper Ionian
Waters, he raises a scream beyond measure which shivers not only
Ocean, but every wave. The terrain that is Italy trembles,
Terrorized down to its core, Mount Etna roars from its crater.
- 675 Roused from the forest, the Cyclops tribe rushes down from the mountain
Heights, races into the harbour and fills up all of the shoreline.
Oh, what a frightening assembly this was, these brothers from Etna,
Standing alert, heads high as the heavens, each eye full of futile
Menace frustrated! We watch them intently. They stand there like oak trees,
- 680 Tall tops towering up into air, like coniferous cypress,
High forests sacred to Jupiter, groves that belong to Diana.
Fear's sharp spurs drive us madly away in whatever direction
Sheets shaken loose let us run, and where following winds tauten canvas,
Flouting Helenus' plea that I not hold a course that meant favouring
- 685 Either Charybdis or Scylla,* routes more or less equally deadly.

'Then we must double back on our course. So we haul round our canvas.

Look now! A northerly breeze picks up from Pelorus's narrow
Headland, I'm swept past Pantagia's estuary, known for its living
Rock caves, on past Megara's gulf, past low-lying Thapsus.

- 690 These Achaemenides shows us, for he is retracing the coastline
He's travelled once before with Ulysses who found no fulfilment.

'Reaching across a Sicilian bay and facing Plemyrion's
Surf-washed shores is an isle men of old called Ortygia. Rumour
Tells that a river in Elis, the Alpheus, brings here by secret

- 695 Passages under the sea to this harbour in Sicily, fresh streams
Spurting assault on the sea through the mouth of your spring, Arethusa.
Passing from here—our respects to the local and powerful spirits
Paid—I then sail past the fertile marshland loam of Helorus.
Next, when we've skirted Pachynus' high cliff peaks and projecting
- 700 Reefs, Camerina appears in the distance, though fate never grants us

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Closer approach, then the plains called Geloan, or "laughing", then Gela,
Named for its mighty river that roars with the thunder of laughter.
Acragas, high on the cliffs, comes next, now displaying its massive
Walls from afar—once famed for its breeding of thoroughbred horses.

- 705 Rising winds let me leave your palms well behind us, Selinus.*

Off Lilybaeum, I thread among sharp reefs lurking in shallows.
Drepanum's harbour* receives me next. But it's no joyous haven.

'Here, alas, not in those high sea's storms that so often beset me,
I lost him who'd brought me to life, Anchises. He lightened

710 Every disaster and care. You left me, my wonderful father,
Here, to exhaustion. Alas, you were saved from such perils for nothing.
This was a grief neither Helenus, seer as he was, in his many
Forecasts of horror, predicted to me, nor did fearsome Celaeno.
This was my hardest test, the decisive turn on a long road.
715 Then a god drove me clear off the course,* to your people and your shores.'

Father Aeneas, a single voice in a hall full of listeners,
Thus retold gods' story of Fate* and explained all his movements.
Now he fell silent at last. His end was accomplished. He rested.

NOTES

1 *After the powers on high had approved*: Aeneas represents the gods as more organized than Virgil 'himself' does, and notes his ritual attempts to gain insight into what he sees as the collective divine will. He also portrays himself as deferential to his father Anchises and conveys his righteousness, *pietas*.

5–7 *we constructed ... Ships*: Homer's Troy had no navy. Aeneas does not explain how he could build and launch a fleet near Troy so soon after Troy fell.

18 *Aeneadae*: Aineia (in Thrace) proclaimed its foundation by Aeneas on coins and held a festival in his honour. It may also have claimed his tomb, which Virgil had to eliminate. Cities seized on myths to link themselves with travellers such as Odysseus and Aeneas. It was not enough to say: 'Aeneas slept here.' He had to sleep *with* someone and have a child or, failing that, die and have a cult tomb. The *Odyssey*, among the first works written down in Greek, could brush aside unwanted prior traditions. But Virgil had to set Aeneas in an established path. See A. Erskine, *Troy between Greece and Rome: Local Tradition and Imperial Power* (Oxford, 2001), 93–8. Aeneas places himself at a tomb rather than in one: that of Polydorus. It is a regally Trojan, yet problematic, substitution, for it makes Aeneas' first landfall just where Agamemnon's Greek fleet stopped on its return voyage: the realm of Polymestor of Thrace (see Euripides' *Hecuba*).

19 *Dione's / Child*: Dione is more often the mother, by Tantalus, of Pelops, the ancestor of the house of Atreus, than the mother of Venus. In using this pedigree for his mother, Aeneas establishes a genealogical link between himself and Agamemnon, son of Atreus. Virgil calls Caesar 'son of Dione' (*Eclogue* 9.47).

45 *Polydorus*: Euripides' *Hecuba* opens with the ghost of Polydorus, son of Priam, telling of his murder by Polymestor. In Pacuvius' lost *Iliona*, it is not Polydorus but Polymestor's own son Deipylus who is killed. Polymestor's wife Ilione (Iliona in Pacuvius) switched the two children when babies, without her husband's knowledge. When Iliona discovered Polymestor's murder of their son she blinded and killed him. In Pacuvius, then, Polydorus survives: if Aeneas arrived after Agamemnon, Polydorus would have been alive and Ilione a widow.

46 *sharp-pointed spear-shafts*: covering the mound are myrtle and dogwood (cornel), both used to make spears and arrows. Aeneas is tugging at weapons that have grown back as the plants from which they were made. In a picture, it might be hard to tell whether he was inserting or extracting the spears. Aeneas has Polydorus' ghost clear him of blame, and gives Euripides', not Pacuvius' account of the Thracian murder. Since Aeneas founds Aeneadae close to the time of Polydorus' murder, some accounts might have shown him

disposing of Polydorus as a rival. Among Aeneas' gifts to Dido are the sceptre and crown of Ilione (1.653), which Aeneas presumably obtained here. How and why they were available to him is a mystery, since Aeneas does not mention meeting Ilione.

78–9 *calmest / Welcome*: Delos, subject to stormy weather, is notoriously difficult to land on or leave.

80 *Anius*: Dionysius (1.59.3) says one of Anius' daughters was given to Aeneas, and that her name was Launa (that is, Lavinia), and that Lavinium was named after her (Erskine, *Troy between Greece and Rome*, 185–8). Virgil does not dispose of this tradition until Book 7 (note to 7.71). Meanwhile Aeneas distracts our attention. He has his father misinterpret an oracle and thus send the Trojans to Crete (not on any prior itinerary for Aeneas). When disaster ensues, Anchises redirects them to Delos. But the return voyage is pre-empted by the household gods who direct Aeneas, finally, to Italy.

94 *Dardanus' rugged sons*: Aeneas shows that Apollo is directing them to Italy, where Dardanus was born. He again emphasizes that he had as yet no clear sense of his family's origins.

107 *Teucer*: Anchises takes the Trojans to be sons of Teucer (that is, Teucrians) and thus of Cretan origin rather than sons of Dardanus (that is, Dardanians) and of Italian origin.

111 *Great Mother*: Cybele. Her cult, linked with Phrygia in Asia Minor, was brought to Rome towards the end of the Second Punic War (Silius 16.1–45). A prophecy claimed that an invading foreign army could be expelled only if Cybele's cult were transferred to Rome. Her festival, the *Megalensia*, became one of Rome's most important. The Corybants were Cybele's followers. Wild dances and music were part of her cult. She had a male consort, Attis, who got into a frenzy or was unfaithful to Cybele (or both), castrated himself, and eventually died—though his body was preserved, at Cybele's request. Cybele's priests, called *galli*, practised self-castration (*Gallus* is a multiple pun in Latin, meaning 'Gaul' and 'rooster' as well as '(castrated) priest'). Roman citizens were not allowed to serve as her priests, and official art, including coins, is silent about Attis. Poets are not. Catullus 63 tells of Attis' self-castration and prays the frenzy won't strike him. But Attis is never mentioned in the *Aeneid*, though there are comments on 'Phrygian' lack of masculinity. To Iarbas, Aeneas is 'helped by his eunuch entourage, this latter-day Paris' (4.215).

121 *Idomeneus*: king of Crete and a major Greek warrior at Troy. He alone reached home with his squad intact, but was exiled for sacrificing his son (having vowed, rashly, to sacrifice the first thing he saw on returning home). Aeneas does not mention until later that Idomeneus was exiled to *Italy*.

147–8 *conscious / Creatures*: Latin *animalia*. That which is *animal*, says Cicero, 'is driven by its own personal and internal motion', as distinct from the inanimate, 'which is acted upon by external force' (*Tusculan Disputations* 1. 23. 54). See also 4.522 ff., 8.26–7, and 9.224.

153 *allay my concerns*: this line is identical with 2.775 and 8.35. I could not make them completely identical in English because of needed changes in gender, verb person, and number.

164 *'Twilight Land'*: Latin *Hesperia* (Gk. *Hesperios*, 'evening'); used of the western Mediterranean generally, but in Virgil usually of Italy.

171 *Ausonia ... Dicte*: Ausonia is a Greek name for Italy (see note to 7.206). *Dicte*, a mountain in Crete famous for its curative herb, dittany, is often used to designate Crete as a whole. Here it also establishes a pun. Jupiter's *dicta* ('decrees') bar Aeneas from *Dicte*'s land. Since no prior tradition sends Aeneas to Crete, it is worth noting that the Cretans were proverbially liars. Odysseus, famous as a liar, assumes a Cretan identity when spinning his false identities in *Odyssey* 13–21.

211 *Harpies*: Aeneas' sequel to a famous episode in Apollonius is his only full encounter with the fantastical creatures of the *Odyssey* and *Argonautica*, though he at least sees Polyphemus the Cyclops later in the book. Homer had situated them beyond the known world, but Apollonius moved them within it. The Harpy episode centres on attempts made by the Trojans to set out tables to dine. And Aeneas is telling the story immediately after the lavish banquet Dido has set for them.

222 *In we rush*: Aeneas describes his arrival as a savage onslaught on an idyllic scene, but never suggests he tried to stop it. In Apollonius, Jason's crew drives the Harpies away from their homeland to save a starving, blind man whom the Harpies attack when he tries to eat. In the *Aeneid*, the Harpies keep possession of their depleted herds and relatively new land (though Celaeno's reference to it as the 'land of our fathers' gives the impression that they have always been there (249)). The episode recalls the attack of Odysseus' last surviving companions on the cattle of the Sun in the *Odyssey*.

241 *foul ... seabirds*: Latin *ob-scenae*, 'kept from display, obscene', acquires a secondary sense in this context of dining (*cena*): *obs-cena*, 'kept from dining'.

247 *Sons of Laomedon*: Laomedon was Priam's father and proverbial for perfidy; see note to 8.157. This is a curious (and ominous) reminder that Trojans cannot always be relied on to keep their word. If Aeneas wants to be able to leave Carthage, he must not make the Trojans (or himself) too appealing to Dido.

250 *Carry on into your minds*: see 10.104, where Jupiter says the same line. In Latin, *accipite ergo* is apt for Celaeno. She is a 'bird of prey' and *accipiter* = 'hawk'. It is apt for Jupiter, too, whose bird is the eagle.

252 *direst of Demons*: Harpies are demons (Latin *Dirae*) associated with famine rather than Furies, the avengers of bloodshed (see note to 6.555). Celaeno's Greek name means 'the Dark One'.

256 *Till dire famine*: this prophecy makes it clear that Dido's ample tables, the setting of Aeneas' narration, cannot mark the end of his travels. Perhaps that is why Aeneas attributes the prophecy of eating tables in desperation to the one mythical monster he claims to have met personally. When one adds the later account (3.622–38) of Polyphemus cracking Ulysses' crewmen like eggs and eating them alive, one can see that Aeneas is deploying themes not ideal for a state banquet, even when tables are removed. See note to 7.122.

270–4 *Zacynthus ... Leucas's cloudy peaks*: tradition had Aeneas visit Zacynthus and Leucas and found temples. Aeneas 'relocates' these traditions to Actium, some distance away. Virgil is intruding his authorial presence here. Octavian defeated Antony and Cleopatra off Actium in 31 BC, in a naval victory that won him control of the Roman world and the opportunity to construct his own New Troy (see note to 8.675). Since Aeneas cannot know about this victory, Virgil is not obliged to digress into panegyric.

288 *Arms from Danaän victors*: a rare reference in epic to writing. The defeated Aeneas celebrates a personal triumph at Actium, memorializing in bronze his victory over a *Danaän* (Greek) warrior whose name is identical with that of Abas, the father of *Danaë*. See note to 7.410. The name 'Aeneas' resembles in spelling the Latin word *aëneus*, 'made of bronze'.

291 *we tuck out of sight*: Latin *abscondimus*. Aeneas bypasses not only Zacynthus and Leucas but the arguably fictional Phaeacia where Odysseus narrates his travels (*Odyssey* 6–12).

295 *Helenus, Priam's son*: Helenus, twin brother of Cassandra, whose prophecies no one believed, supported Troy until Paris' death, then left Troy, offended that Priam had given the widowed Helen to Deiphobus (see 6.494 ff. and notes), not to him. Since only he knew how the Greeks could take Troy, the Greeks captured him. He told them that success required the help of Pyrrhus and of Philoctetes, heir to the bow of Hercules (Sophocles, *Philoctetes* 603–21). He also saved Pyrrhus' life by advising him to return to Greece by land when the war ended (most of those who returned by sea died in shipwrecks). The grateful Pyrrhus made Helenus heir to his possessions, which included Andromache, Hector's widow, awarded as a war-prize (Euripides, *Andromache* and *Trojan Women*). Helenus and Andromache moved to Buthrotum in Epirus. Later Macedonian and Epirote kings claimed links with all three. Alexander the Great's mother was said to be the descendant of both Helenus and

Pyrrhus. King Pyrrhus (who invaded Italy in 280 BC) named his son Helenus. See Erskine, *Troy between Greece and Rome*, 122–3.

309 *she could speak*: Aeneas, on poor terms with Hector's family in the *Iliad*, foregrounds his brusque treatment of Andromache, but also shows that neither Andromache nor Helenus holds any ill-will for him. The scene resonates with echoes of tragedy; uncannily so, since Aeneas' voice predates the works it echoes.

317 *what befell to uplift you*: Aeneas' emphasis on 'picking up' the 'fallen' Andromache highlights the sense of 'falling'—in Latin, *casus*, 'event, chance'—an apposite metaphor for Andromache's sorrows: her son had been 'allowed to fall', as Seneca's Calchas says, 'from the top of a high tower' (see note to 2.457).

319 *spousal relations*: this phrase doesn't say: 'Are you still enslaved to a marriage with Pyrrhus?' Latin has *servare*, 'maintain', not *servire*, 'be a slave to'. Aeneas' question is cruel; for he has already heard of Pyrrhus' death and of Andromache's marriage to Helenus.

322 *Single daughter left virgin*: Polyxena, daughter of Priam, was sacrificed on Achilles' grave by Pyrrhus.

330 *now enter Orestes*: the most frequently occurring character in surviving Greek tragedy. Andromache is aware of herself as a character in drama and draws on Euripides' play about her, *Andromache*. In it, her life is threatened by Hermione, Pyrrhus' jealous Greek wife, until Orestes arrives with Pyrrhus' body and ready to marry Hermione himself. Her Orestes, 'maddened by ghosts of his crimes', is echoed, with slight modification, in 4.471 where Orestes is 'driven mad in a drama'. Among his crimes was the killing of his mother, Clytemnestra, to avenge her killing of his father, Agamemnon.

341 *his lost mother*: Aeneas has Andromache affirm his account of Creusa's death (though how she knows about it isn't clear). Ascanius remembers her, as we see in 9.298; Aeneas never refers to her again after this.

348 *sob through the flood*: Aeneas, aptly, uses *singula* for the 'individual' words interrupted by Helenus' weeping, since it suggests *singultus*, 'sobbing'.

382 *Ignorant man*: Aeneas has Helenus reaffirm what he himself insists on in Books 2 and 3: his own ignorance. Why Juno has the power to censor Apollo's seer is unclear. So too is the line between Helenus' ignorance and what censorship forbids him to say.

390–2 *Under the bankside's ... in a cluster*: repeated at 8.43–6, see note there and on 8.85. I make the sow albino, not simply white (as in Latin), to keep the pun on Alba (*alba* = 'white'). Some think there is a pun on Troia (Troy) and *troia*, a word for 'sow' not found until over five

hundred years after Virgil. Romans loved puns too much to miss one so obvious for so long if it had been available.

395 *Fates will discover a way*: Jupiter uses the same words in 10.113.

405 *mantle of purple*: Romans veiled their heads for sacrifice; Greeks did not.

443 *mad seer*: the Sibyl of Cumae; see note to 6.10 for details.

464–5 *sawn elephantine / Ivory*: the epithet 'sawn' makes the phrase echo *Odyssey* 19.562–7 (see note to 6.893). Latin *elephantus*, 'elephant', rarely means 'ivory'. The usual word is *ebur*. Virgil probably has Aeneas use this expression because Romans got their first glimpse of elephants when Pyrrhus of Epirus (Helenus' distant successor) invaded Italy in 280 BC and brought war-elephants. He defeated the Romans but lost so many troops that he had to withdraw: hence the phrase, 'a Pyrrhic victory'. Statues were sometimes decorated with a combination of gold and ivory, most famously that of Athena in the Parthenon at Athens.

466 *Brought from Dodona*: site of a shrine of Jupiter, reputedly the oldest oracle in Greece, plundered and destroyed first in the third century BC and again by the Romans in 168–167 BC. The Latin indicates the origin of these cauldrons, not whether they reached Helenus as 'imports' or 'plunder'. 'Neoptolemus' armour' takes the ambiguous imagery further. Neoptolemus (another name for Pyrrhus) had been denied possession of his father's armour. So his own armour marks a new start. When Helenus inherits it he is marked as Pyrrhus' heir. In passing it on to Aeneas, Helenus makes Aeneas his heir and betrays his Epirote New Troy as he reportedly betrayed Old Troy. Aeneas' descendants will destroy Buthrotum and refound it as a Roman colony. All Aeneas can see is the armour of the youth over whose shoulder he saw into the palace of Old Troy as it fell to the Greeks.

484 *a Phrygian cloak*: Andromache honours Ascanius as the image of her dead Astyanax, who is himself the image of his father Hector. In Seneca's *Trojan Women*, based on Greek originals, she keeps Astyanax's cloak as he is taken to be killed because it has been touched by Hector's ashes. She defines herself here by her past, speaking of herself not as Helenus' wife, but as Hector's.

499 *hindrance to Greeks*: Aeneas' self-narrated prophesy is grim with irony, as he holds Pyrrhus' armour.

507 *shortest of crossings*: Aeneas does not cross from Onchesmus (the traditional point), probably because it claimed Anchises' grave, which Aeneas places in Sicily.

515 *progression of stars*: these constellations are not all visible at the same moment, so Palinurus' observations take time. Line 516 repeats 1.744, which refers to the skies as presented by the Carthaginian poet Iopas. But when Aeneas adds Orion in the next line, the

picture changes. Orion was proverbially menacing to sailors, particularly in winter, when it rises close to dawn. Hesiod warns sailors to secure their ships to land then; Polybius says a Roman fleet was lost because it sailed just after the rising of Orion. In summer, Orion rises around midnight. So Palinurus times his own rising to observe Orion's appearance in the skies.

526 *unmixed wine*: Romans, like Greeks, diluted wine with water.

541 *trained for the chariot*: the notion of the chariot as symbolic of peace is puzzling. Chariots were vehicles of war in many ancient societies. But Romans normally used chariots for races. Chariots are a sensitive topic for Aeneas, who lost his to Diomedes in *Iliad* 5. He always fights on foot in the *Aeneid*.

553 *the sailor's / Graveyard*: not simply an allusion to a remote myth of singing mermaids luring sailors to death upon the rocks. In 42 BC Octavian had seen the wreckage when Sextus Pompey defeated his navy off that same Scyllaeen promontory; Scylla and Charybdis were not just poetic images for him.

578 *Enceladus' body*: see Glossary; most writers say it is Typhoeus (Typhon) under Etna.

610 *Anchises ... took his hand*: Anchises plays the welcoming role Priam played to Sinon in Book 2. But Achaemenides is not part of a Greek plot to destroy the Trojans. This incident is probably Aeneas' fiction. It has no known precursor and Achaemenides is not mentioned elsewhere in the *Aeneid*. Aeneas positions himself in Odysseus' wake, claims moral superiority over Odysseus, and subverts the tradition that Odysseus was the lone survivor of his voyage. Yet there's a flaw. Odysseus visits the Cyclopes in the first year or so of his travels. Aeneas, starting at about the same time, meets Achaemenides in his sixth year. Since Achaemenides claims he has been stranded just three months, the chronology doesn't fit. What the narrative does achieve, however, is to move Aeneas close enough to Ulysses (that is, Odysseus) in his travels that their paths almost cross in Sicily: at a safe distance from Rome. For one troublesome strand of the tradition makes Aeneas joint founder of Rome with Odysseus. The emphasis on Ulysses as *infelix*, 'who found no fulfilment', is therefore important.

684–5 *that I hold not ... Charybdis or Scylla*: most manuscripts have *teneant*, 'that they hold'. But the sense requires either *teneamus*, 'that we hold' (which won't scan) or *teneam*, 'that I hold', which scans and is supported by several editors. The shortest crossing between Sicily and Italy is at the Straits of Messina (now bridged), notorious for difficult currents and linked mythically with Scylla (which tears ships apart) and Charybdis (which swallows ships beneath its surface).

705 *Selinus*: named for the wild celery, the emblem on its coins and used to make the victor's garland at the Isthmian games. Selinus was destroyed in 409 BC, rebuilt, destroyed again during the Second Punic War, then abandoned. So there is pathos underlying Aeneas' jesting remark. 'Palms', as in English, are both palm trees and the generic term for top honours awarded at games, as well as the palms of the hand.

707 *Drepanum's harbour*: the westernmost port on his circumnavigation of Sicily, the turning point before the home stretch to Italy. But Juno's storm sends Aeneas off the course altogether, to Carthage. Much of western Sicily, including Drepanum, was controlled by or allied with Carthage until the end of the Second Punic War. Drepanum is a fair distance from Segesta, where Aeneas celebrates games in honour of Anchises (Book 5), but the tradition that Segesta was founded by Trojans dates back at least as far as Thucydides (6.2) in the fifth century BC.

715 *a god drove me clear off the course*: Aeneas' last words show Carthage is not his destination but an unwanted digression. This land belongs to 'your' (*vestris*) people, not to us. Again, he publicly, though diplomatically, rejects Dido's offer to share Carthage. These are his last words in direct speech until 4.333, where he reaffirms the point directly in private conversation with Dido.

716 *gods' story of Fate*: Aeneas has indeed reframed 'the tale of destiny' in his own terms.